the precious treasure.

27. What lesson can be learnt from this story?
28. Do you think it is easier for a boy or a girl to keep a secret?
29. Why is it wrong to let out a secret you have been told?
30. What do you think was the chief fault in the character of Subha Datta?

For more books to read and have fun : https://americanliterature.com/short-stories-for-children

USAGE

USAGE TRAPS

Usage refers to the customary manner in which language is spoken or written by its educated users. Usage is a mine field. Unless you are careful you are likely to be trapped.

e.g. 'The teacher was not satisfied about the performance of the boy' is wrong. It should be 'satisfied with.'

Here are some common usage errors. The correct form is given for your guidance.

able

☒ Sophia said that the library book was not able to be found.
☐ Sophia said that she was unable to find the library book. (OR)
☐ Sophia said that she was not able to find the library book.

* The subject of be able/unable is a person, not a thing.

absent

☒ Ramya is absent in class today.
☐ Ramya is absent from class today.

* We say that someone is absent from class, school, work etc., not 'in' or 'to'

alone

☒ She was very alone at first but then she made some friends.
☐ She was very lonely at first but then she made some friends.
☐ She was all alone at home.

* alone—without people around you
* lonely - feeling of being alone

homework

☒ Our teachers give us a lot of homeworks and it is difficult to finish them.
☐ Our teachers give us a lot of homework and it is difficult to finish it.

* homework is used only in singular form .

consult

☒ They decided to consult with the counsellor.
☐ They decided to consult a counsellor.

contain

☒ Both bottles were containing acetic acid.
☐ Both bottles contained acetic acid.

* 'contain' is not used in continuous tense (But we say a bottle containing acetic acid)

describe

☒ In the composition she described about her garden.
☐ In the composition she described her garden.

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